Overview

This is a non-parametric local regression graph for the Wikipedia page “Opinion polling for the 46th Canadian federal election”, specifically the section “Government approval”.

Current version:

Acknowledgements

Based off of this person’s code on GitLab, which was used for LOESS regressions of election polls (from polling firms such as Abacus Data, Léger, and Ipsos) on Wikipedia, such as this one.

The previous graph (as seen below) was made by Wikipedia user ST2407 but stopped being updated for a long time and was removed by them from Wikipedia.

CSV Updates

`update_polls.py` checks the Wikipedia page’s “Table of polls” section daily for new government approval polls, parses the wikitext directly (rather than scraping rendered HTML), and appends any new rows to `carney government approval polls.csv`, skipping firms listed in `Which polling firms to inlcude.md`. This runs via a scheduled GitHub Actions workflow, which also re-renders the LOESS plot and opens a GitHub issue summarizing any new polls when the CSV changes. I will also try to update the original Wikipedia table with new polls. A future project could be to scrape new polls directly from the pollters websites.

Which polling firms to include (broken down into already included on Wikipedia and not already included) and which ones should not be incuded (ex. because they PM poll Carney favourability rather than approval).

Polls that are included are both PM Carney’s personal approval and government approval, just not his personal favourability.

Also, I should do a hypothesis test at 5% significance level if there actually is a difference between government approval and PM Carney’s personal approval.

I will try to see if I can add more (wrote “done” in the chart below for the pollsters that I checked to make sure that I included all compatible polls).

Included already:	To include:	Do not include:
Abacus Data	Ekos	Nanos Research
Innovative Research	Research Co.	Mainstreet Research
Spark Insights	Angus Reid	Pallas Data
Léger	-	Kolosowski Strategies
Ipsos (done)	-	Pollera
Liaison Strategies (someone added 38 of them on one day!)	-	-